By all of which his purity of motive is proved.

Mr Sin Shen says that his family have, for two hundred years, have lived in peace and happiness, and that he himself, for his merits, in connection with military affairs, has frequently received from his Imperial Majesty, being rewarded twice with feathers, and, at last, with genuine pearls. He thinks he ought to attend to his duties with disinterestedness, and bear his own expenses and serve faithfully his Government. Therefore he requests that his original salary of thirty six taels a month be stopped, in order that it may be manifest that he is entirely free from covetousness.

Hereafter, both at Taohow and Amoy, if there be any public matters for him to attend to, he is willing, with his whole heart, and strength, and at all times to render service, in order that the affairs between China and foreign nations may become still more amicables.

Therefore it is proper that I, according to his wish, make this communication in his behalf to your Excellencies, requesting you to examine into the truth of these things, and kindly grant his wishes.

I take this opportunity to send my respects etc etc.

Ho Wun, Tartar General and Governor General, and Wang, Governor.

January 18 1872.

a true copy
Chas. LeGendre
U.S.C.

Inclosure

4/19

DEPARTMENT OF STATE RECEIVED OUT APR 1 1872

[No. 46]

UNITED STATES CONSULATE AMOY.

Mr. Chas W LeGendre

To the Department of State.

ASSIGNMENT LODGED APR 15 1872

Subject Intended visit to Southern Formosa.

Abstract of Contents

Intended visit to Southern Formosa.

Telegraph dispatch from Hon. W. H. Seward.

Steamer Schuyler placed at the disposal of Mr Consul.

[No 163]

UNITED STATES CONSULATE

Hong Kong ~~XXXX~~ February 15th 1872

HON. ASSISTANT SECRETARY of STATE,

WASHINGTON, D.C.

Sir,

I have stated in my report on trade for the year ending 31st September, 1871, forwarded with my Dispatch No 155 on the 5th of January last, that I had been informed through H.B.M. Consul that the Chief of the Aborigines in Southern Formosa had on several occasions, inquired after me and expressed a great desire to see me in order that we might renew the friendly agreement entered into between us in 1864. I further stated that, although there are considerable difficulties attending such trips over the Formosa seas in foreign vessels or native boats I should gladly have gone again to Southern Formosa if I had been in possession of

instructions of some sort from the Minister. But, until replies to the inquiries which I have made in my Nos. 43 and 53 dated March 31st, 1869 and March 1st, 1870 have been received, I am compelled to remain inactive at Amoy.

Subsequently, however I communicated unofficially with the Consul-General, Mr. H. A. Seward, upon the subject and, on the 11th of January I received a telegram from Mr. Seward, dated January 6th, informing me that the "Ashuelot" would visit Amoy and Formosa; but, owing to bad weather and other causes, the Ashuelot had not reached Amoy on the 2nd of February, and at that time I was compelled to leave my post on account of sickness and go to Hongkong for a change of air, where I had the benefit of a consultation with Admiral Rodgers, who has offered me his cordial cooperation should I desire to visit Formosa.

It is very plain that, unless I leave early in March, owing to the stormy weather that prevails after April, I shall have to wait another year before I can venture in those dangerous seas and the delay might afterwards prove to be a cause for much regret. On the other hand, it is self-evident that, under general instructions, I am always justified in cooperating with our naval officers in combined measures for the suppression of piracy; and, therefore, I have decided to avail myself of the facilities so courteously offered to me by our Admiral for the object in view.

I shall return to Amoy on the 16th inst. Upon my arrival there I shall place myself in communication with the Governor-General of Foochow by special courier. If I can induce him to dispatch a deputy to Formosa in one of his own steam war vessels, I shall do so. Should I fail in this, I shall go there alone

with the "Ashuelot" and do what I can with the Governor of the Island, with whom I am on the most intimate terms and who was sent there over a year ago at my own suggestion. At all events it shall be my constant aim to proceed in such a way as not to wound the susceptibilities of the Chinese or to interfere with the lawful jurisdiction which the Government of the Empire claims over the unsubdued aboriginal districts of the Island, and which I may be called upon to visit. —

I have the honor to be

Sir

Your Obedient Servant

Chas. E. Le Gendre